

Woman at a Crosswalk

sspboyd X Bobby collaboration

April, 2023

This token is part of the SESSIONS SERIES co-curated by the NFT Museum of Newberry, SC and Fort Gallery NFT.

Project Description

Bobby:

Fifteen years ago, a woman stood at a crosswalk in my hometown of Oklahoma City, momentarily gazing and gesturing toward the horizon. At that moment, I was passing time taking random photographs as I waited for a friend.

Weeks or months later, I noticed the photograph and made a drawing based on the woman at the crosswalk. In the drawing, I dialed up the drama of her expression and gesture, gave her a theatrical hair style, and placed her in a field of tall flowers at night.

I used the drawing to make a screen print. The screen print was exhibited at a handful of local venues in the years that followed, and was one of the first pieces I minted as an NFT in the spring of 2021 (later collected by the illustrious Anna Condo).

I used the screen print as a seed image to create images in Midjourney, which began my 'Thousandfold' collection. I took images from the first generation of Thousandfold as seed images for the second generation, images from the second generation as seed images for the third generation, and images from the third generation as seed images for the fourth generation. I haven't stopped there, but in the fourth generation, the figures (for whatever reason) turned to face the viewer. These are the images used for this collaboration.

Just when I thought this particular series had gone about as far as it could go, Stephen came along and did some truly magical things.

sspboyd:

This collaboration plays with the ideas of light and shadow; deconstruction and recreation.

Each edition begins by selecting the light or shadow side of one of Bobby's images and making that the "mask" to be recreated. The remaining images are also divided into light and shadow and placed in a way that attempts to recreate the original mask image.

It is a volatile algorithm that spans a wide variety of outputs and in one moment can create readily identifiable images and the next moment pure abstractions with no recognizable features.

Features

1. Mask Name
2. Number of Unique Faces
3. Mask is: Figure or Ground. This defines whether the light or shadow component of the mask is being recreated.
4. Number of Layers
5. Rotation Alignment
6. Base Colour

Interaction

Export to PNG

Press s: your current screen size

Press m: Max size @ 7027px x 7027px

Background

Press b: Toggle background colour between black and white

Mouse Interaction

Moving the mouse over the image rotates the faces and reveals more of the layering.

Acknowledgements

sspboyd:

Thank you to @Robert_Matheson and @VeeeeColeman for inviting me to participate in this

collaboration. And thank you to Bobby for being a joy to work with!

As always, none of this is possible without my family. Thank you the most to KIRH.

Software Libraries and other technology used for development

Software Libraries:

Made with Processing / P5.js

p5.js v1.5.0

Hardware used for development:

MacBook Pro (13-inch, 2019)

Dell U2723QE

Version Control

<https://github.com/sspboyd/SESSIONS>

This repo is private as of April 2023. However, I have provided a source map with this project so please feel free to browse the code and see how it all works. There are a number of comments in the code explaining what is happening at different points.

License info

See [LICENSE.md](#)

This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License

<http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/>

Code copyright by Stephen Boyd

Audio and Visual Media Assets copyright by Bobby

NFT copyright shared by Stephen Boyd and Bobby

Bios

sspboyd

Stephen Boyd is a Toronto based artist creating prints and interactive works with code since 2004.

For the last 20 years, Stephen has explored the idea of layers: the layering and interacting of simple patterns written in code, repeating millions of times to create beauty through emergent structure.

Stephen has exhibited his prints and installation work in solo and group shows. He has presented at the Marshall McLuhan Festival, Siggraph, and held an Artist-in-Residence position at Centennial College.

Stephen's influences range from early generative artists of the 1960s such as Manfred Mohr and Vera Molnár to Sol LeWitt and more recently Casey Reas, co-founder of Processing.

Stephen graduated from the Canadian Film Centre's New Media H@bitat program. A lack of formal CompSci education has allowed him to evolve a unique process and style to his work. Stephen's current work focuses on creating generative collections.

Find me online @sspboyd. Please say hi!

- [fxhash](https://www.fxhash.xyz/u/sspboyd), <https://www.fxhash.xyz/u/sspboyd>
- [Website](http://sspboyd.ca), <http://sspboyd.ca> & stephen@sspboyd.ca
- [Instagram](https://www.instagram.com/sspboyd/), <https://www.instagram.com/sspboyd/>
- [GitHub](https://github.com/sspboyd), <https://github.com/sspboyd>
- [Twitter](https://twitter.com/sspboyd), <https://twitter.com/sspboyd>
- [Mastodon](https://genart.social/@sspboyd), <https://genart.social/@sspboyd>

Bobby

Based in Tulsa, Oklahoma, Bobby (also known as Mantis) is a musician and visual artist working in a variety of media; including various forms of printmaking, drawing, photography, and artificial intelligence.

He is on the teams for Flower Girls and The Stoics by Gabe Weis; and was a contributing artist to Mythologicals and the Decentralized Project.

Prior to joining the NFT space, Bobby was an exhibiting artist for over 15 years, showing art in

galleries and invitational exhibits all over his home state.

Since entering Web3 in 2021, he has sold over 450 NFTs on the Ethereum, Polygon, and Tezos blockchains. He was featured in Fort Gallery's exhibits at Art Basel Miami 2021 and NFT NYC 2022; and in LAi Museum's "So Far, So Near" exhibit in Asturias, Spain in 2022.